Remington Model 870 Shotguns

Remington Arms / RemArms • The World's Most Produced Pump Shotgun (12 Gauge & 20 Gauge Wingmaster / Express)

Manufacturer:	Remington Arms / RemArms	**Category:**	Shotguns
Action Type:	Slide-Action / Pump-Action Repeating Shotgun	**Era / Service:**	American Pump Standard (1950–Present)
Calibers:	12 Gauge (2-3/4" & 3" Mag), 20 Gauge	**Covered Models:**	Model 870 Wingmaster (Polished Blue), Model 870 Express, Model 870 Police Magnum, Model 870 Tactical

KEY ARMORER TASKS & BENCH OPERATIONS

Core Procedures: Shell Latch Staking (Dedicated 870 Staking Tool) • Flex-Tab Anti-Jam Conversion Inspection • Ejector Spring Riveting Replacement • Dual Action Bar Timing & Truing • Magazine Tube Dimple Swaging / Drilling

CRITICAL ARMORER TOLERANCES & SPECIFICATIONS

SPECIFICATION / CLEARANCE	ARMORER TOLERANCE & BENCH SPECIFICATION
RECEIVER MATERIAL	Milled from a single solid billet of ordnance grade steel for lifetime durability
DUAL ACTION BARS	Twin steel action bars prevent binding or twisting during aggressive pumping
SHELL LATCHES	Left and right spring-steel shell latches staked inside receiver walls hold shells in magazine tube; require specialized staking tool if dislodged
FLEX TAB CONVERSION	Carrier modified with 'U' shaped cutout and modified breech bolt allows user to clear shell over carrier jam by cycling pump
EJECTOR SPRING	Riveted into left inside receiver wall; replaced by drilling old rivet and restaking

IMMEDIATE ACTION & MALFUNCTION DIAGNOSTIC MATRIX

MALFUNCTION CONDITION	PROBABLE CAUSES	ARMORER BENCH REMEDY
Stoppage 1: Shell Over Carrier Jam (Action Locked Shut with Live Round) **Cartridge slips out of magazine tube onto top of closed carrier while bolt is locked; pump cannot be racked**	• Weak or improperly staked shell latch allowing cartridge to bypass latch. • Older pre-1980 non-Flex-Tab bolt and carrier assembly installed.	**Immediate Action (with Flex-Tab): Force pump handle rearward with heel of hand; the Flex-Tab notch bends around the cartridge rim, chambering the round. Gunsmith Action: Check left and right shell latch staking using Remington 870 staking tool. Restake latches firmly into receiver grooves.**
Stoppage 2: Stuck Empty Hull in Chamber After Firing (Sticky Extraction) **Round fires, but pump handle requires mortar strike on ground to extract fired plastic hull**	• Inexpensive steel-based promotional shot shells expanding into rough micro-grooves in chamber. • Machining ridges inside factory Express chamber.	**Gunsmith Action: Wrap 0000 steel wool soaked in Kroil around an old 12-gauge bronze brush attached to cleaning rod section. Chuck into cordless drill. Polish chamber at medium speed for 90 seconds until mirror-smooth. Replace factory MIM extractor with non-MIM forged steel Police extractor.**

CURATED BENCH VIDEO REFERENCES

PROCEDURE TITLE	INSTRUCTOR / CREATOR	TECHNICAL PROCEDURE SUMMARY
Remington 870 Complete Armorer Disassembly & Flex-Tab Fix	Brownells Gunsmithing Bench	Full armorer teardown of the Remington 870: trigger plate assembly, shell latches, ejector spring replacement, and polishing sticky chambers.